

JERIK CRUZ

positions	Harvard University , Kennedy School of Government (Start Sept. 2026) Postdoctoral Fellow, Reimagining the Economy Project & Harvard Center for International Development
education	Massachusetts Institute of Technology (Sept. 2020 - Sept. 2026) PhD in Political Science <i>Dissertation:</i> World Wide Webs: How Migrant Networks and Porous Bureaucracies Forged the Knowledge Economy in the Global South <i>Fields:</i> Political Economy, Quantitative Methods, Comparative Politics <i>Awards:</i> NSF/APSA Doctoral Dissertation Improvement Grant, MIT Presidential Fellowship Graduate Institute of International and Development Studies (Geneva, CHE) Master in Development Studies Ateneo de Manila University (Manila, PHL) A.B in Economics, Minor in Philosophy
research interests	Comparative & international political economy; bureaucracy; industrial policy; technology; democracy. Computational and historical methods. <i>Area focus:</i> Southeast Asia, North/Central America.
work in progress	“World Wide Webs: How Migrant Networks and Porous Bureaucracies Forged the Knowledge Economy in the Global South” (Job Market Paper) ★ 2026 Best Paper in Science, Technology & Environmental Politics, American Political Science Association ★ 2026 Best Paper in Comparative Policy, American Political Science Association “Bayesian inference and typological thinking: an integrated framework for typological & computational research” ★ 2026 Emerging Methodologist, American Political Science Association QMMR Section “From precarity to illiberalism: the political economy of democratic erosion in the Philippines” (with Rico La Viña) Mapping the global landscape of industrial policy bureaucracies, 1989-2010 The digital developmental state (with Andrew Stokols) Social connectedness and political populism: the rise of the American far-right revisited (with Joohye Jeong) OpenAudit: advancing governance research with LLM-processed government audit reports (with Uriel Galace) ★ 2023 MIT Prize for Open Data
selected publications	with E. de la Cruz. 2023. “Platforming populism: the services transition, precarious urbanization, and digital platforms in the rise of illiberal populism in the Philippines.” <i>Cambridge Journal of Regions, Economy and Society</i> . Special Issue: <i>The Power of Platforms</i> 16(12): 269-288 with M. Montes. 2020. “The political economy of foreign investment and industrial development: the Philippines, Malaysia and Thailand in perspective.” <i>Journal of the Asia-Pacific Economy</i> 25(1): 16-39. 2019. “Great Transformations: The Political Economy of Megaproject Development in the Manila Peri-Urban Periphery.. in <i>Making Sense of the City: Public Space in the Philippines</i> Barbaza, R. (ed.). Manila: Ateneo de Manila University Press. ★ Lead Chapter and Finalist, 2022 Philippine National Book Awards

selected fellowships	APSA Qualitative and Multi-Method Research Section Emerging Methodologist	2026
	Massachusetts Institute of Technology Social and Ethical Responsibilities of Computing Scholar	2025
	Tagpuan Center, Ateneo de Manila University Fellow for Bridging Cultural Divides	2025
	Institute for Humane Studies Junior Fellow	2024, 2025
	Harvard Kennedy School Program on Science, Technology, and Society Predoctoral Fellow	2023
	Mercatus Center, George Mason University Adam Smith Fellow	2023
	Southeast Asia Research Group Pre-Dissertation Fellowship	2022
	Ronald Coase Institute Ronald Coase Institute Fellowship	2020
selected grants and awards	APSA Public Policy Section Best Comparative Policy Paper Award	2026
	APSA Science, Technology, & Environmental Politics Section Paul Sabatier Best Paper Award	2026
	Institute for Human Studies Humane Studies Fellowship (Total: \$5,000)	2026
	Microsoft AI Economy Institute 2nd Global Research Call (with A. Stokols, H. Vo) (Total: \$75,000)	2025
	NSF/APSA Doctoral Dissertation Improvement Grant Award (Total: \$15,400)	2024
	MIT GOV/LAB MIT GOV/LAB Seed Grant (Total: \$10,000)	2022, 2024
	MIT Center for International Studies Summer Study Research Grant (Total: \$7,600)	2023, 2024
	MIT School of Science and MIT Libraries MIT Open Data Prize	2023
	Ateneo de Manila University Research Council Conglomerates and Inclusive Growth (\$65,000)	2018
selected presentations	International Development Research Centre Economics of Tobacco Control Initiative (\$200,000)	2018
	American Political Science Association	2023, 2025, 2026 (Scheduled)
	International Political Economy Society	2026 (Scheduled)
	Midwest Political Science Association, IL	2023, 2025, 2026
	El Colegio de México, Mexico City	2026
	University of Oxford, Saïd Business School Research Seminar	2025
	Qualitative Bayesian Reasoning Network Workshop (Online)	2023, 2025
	Harvard-MIT-Boston University Cambridge Chinese Politics Research Workshop, MA	2024
selected teaching	<i>Massachusetts Institute of Technology</i>	
	Political Science Laboratory: Regression and Causal Inference, Instructor (UG)	Spring 2025
	Quantitative Methods I: Regression Foundations, Teaching Assistant (G)	Fall 2023
	<i>Ateneo de Manila University</i>	
	International Political Economy, Instructor (UG/G)	Spring 2020
leadership and service	Courses in Economics and Development Economics, Instructor (UG)	2017-2019
	Co-Founder and Organizer, MIT Computational Social Science Graduate Student Workshop	2025
	Committee for the MIT Open Data Prize, MIT Open Data Prize	2024, 2025
	Board Member and Communications Chair, 70 Amherst Graduate House Government	2023-2025
	Mentor, MIT Political Science Graduate Mentorship Program	2022-2023, 2024-2025
selected policy work	<i>Reviewer: Perspective on Politics, Competition & Change, Journal of Contemporary Asia</i>	
	Open Society Foundations	New York, USA
	Consultant, Asia-Pacific Program	2023

	The Asia Foundation <i>Lead Technical Advisor, Coalitions for Change Program</i>	Manila, PHL 2023
	United Nations Development Program <i>Political Scientist Consultant, Pintig Lab and COVID-19 FASSSTER project</i>	Manila, PHL 2020-2022
selected policy publications	J. Cruz and E. La Vina. 2024. “The services transition, platform capitalism, and the path to illiberal populism: insights from the Philippines” in <i>Understanding the drivers of political polarization and social exclusion in Southeast Asia</i> . New York: Open Society Foundations	
	J. Cruz and E. La Vina. 2023. “From Dependency to Autonomy: Local Governance, Fiscal Capacity, and the Outlook for Philippine Local Governments in the post-COVID era,” in <i>Decentralization, Digitalization, and Development</i> Manila: United Nations Development Program (lead flagship report chapter)	
selected professional experience	Ateneo de Manila University <i>Lecturer, Department of Economics</i> <i>Economist</i> (Business & Government Program), Ateneo School of Government	Manila, PHL 2017-2020 2017-2019
	United Nations Research Institute for Social Development <i>Research Assistant</i>	Geneva, CHE 2015
selected additional training	Systems Science for Social Impact, WashU in St. Louis Institute for Qualitative and Multi-Method Research, Syracuse University Bayesian Reasoning for Qualitative Social Science, London School of Economics Asia Institute for Political Economy, University of Hong Kong and Georgetown University	2021 (Network Analysis), 2025 (ABM) 2024 2022 2009
computing	R, STATA, Python, $\LaTeX$, HTML, Markdown, GitHub, Qualtrics, MS Office	
languages	English (Native), Tagalog (Native), French (Intermediate), Spanish (Intermediate), Mandarin (Beginner)	
references	Ben Ross Schneider Ford International Professor Massachusetts Institute of Technology Department of Political Science brs@mit.edu	In Song Kim Associate Professor Massachusetts Institute of Technology Department of Political Science insong@mit.edu
	Volha Charnysh Ford Career Development Associate Professor Massachusetts Institute of Technology Department of Political Science charnysh@mit.edu	Kenneth Oye Professor Emeritus Massachusetts Institute of Technology Department of Political Science oye@mit.edu